

“The Saintly Glutton”

There was a **preacher** who used to **go around urging** people to lead **saintly** lives. One day he **preached** a powerful **sermon** against **gluttony**.

“Do you know what happens to people who **gorge** on food!” he **thundered**. “There’s a big glass pillar in Hell. The devil heats it till it is red-hot and then...”

He paused for effect, noting with satisfaction that some people in the audience who obviously loved food had turned **pale**.

“...And then they **line up** the **gluttons** and slowly pull each of them through a tiny hole in the pillar. Imagine the **excruciating** pain!”

After the sermon as he was going to his **lodgings**, he met the town’s richest man.

“I had planned to invite you to dinner,” said the man. “But now I realise that you may not approve of the table I set. You are a saintly man and I...”

“Say no more!” said the preacher. “Let’s go to your house and eat.”

And eat they did. The preacher put away an **enormous** quantity of food, much to the **astonishment** of his host.

“Did you not say that **glut**... I mean, people with large **appetites** would be sent through a small hole in a red-hot pillar?” he asked.

“I did and they do,” said the preacher, **wiping** his mouth with the back of his fat hand.

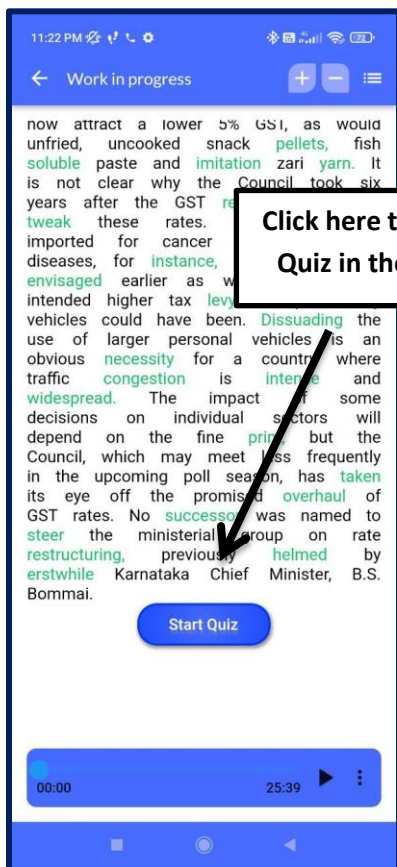
“But fear not. Millions and millions of people have gone through that hole and now it is so big that even an elephant can pass through it without touching the sides.”



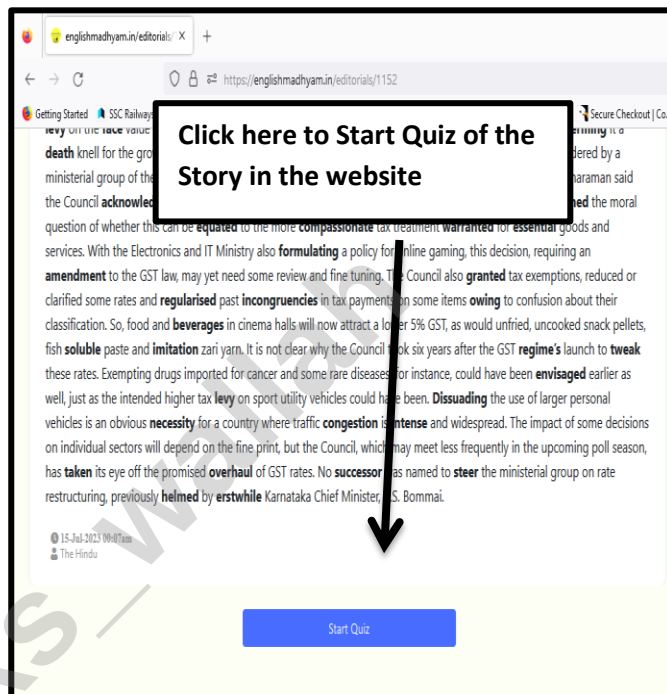
Vocabulary

1. **Preacher** (noun) – evangelist, minister, clergyman, missionary, sermonizer
धर्मोपदेशक
2. **Go around** (phrasal verb) – wander, travel, circulate, move about, roam – इधर-उधर जाना
3. **Urge** (verb) – advise, encourage, implore, press, exhort – आग्रह करना
4. **Saintly** (adverb) – piously, virtuously, divinely, righteously, spiritually – संतवत् ढंग से
5. **Preach** (verb) – sermonize, advocate, proclaim, teach, spread – उपदेश देना
6. **Sermon** (noun) – discourse, preaching, homily, lecture, exhortation – उपदेश
7. **Gluttony** (noun) – overeating, greed, indulgence, ravenousness, excess – अधिक खाने की लालच
8. **Gorge** (verb) – overeat, devour, stuff, gobble, binge – ठूस-ठूस कर खाना
9. **Thunder** (verb) – roar, bellow, shout, boom, exclaim – गरजना / गूंजना
10. **Pale** (adjective) – ashen, white, colorless, wan, pallid – पीला / मुरझाया हुआ
11. **Line up** (phrasal verb) – queue, form a line, arrange, assemble, order – कतार में लगना
12. **Glutton** (noun) – overeater, gourmand, binge-eater, hog, foodie – पेटू / ज्यादा खाने वाला
13. **Excruciating** (adjective) – agonizing, unbearable, intense, tormenting, severe – अत्यंत पीड़ादायक
14. **Lodging** (noun) – accommodation, residence, dwelling, shelter, housing – आवास / ठहरने की जगह
15. **Enormous** (adjective) – huge, massive, gigantic, immense, colossal – विशाल / बहुत बड़ा
16. **Astonishment** (noun) – surprise, amazement, wonder, disbelief, shock – आश्चर्य / हैरानी
17. **Glut** (noun) – surplus, excess, oversupply, abundance, overload – अत्यधिक मात्रा
18. **Appetite** (noun) – hunger, desire, craving, longing, urge – भूख / इच्छा
19. **Wipe** (verb) – clean, rub, dry, mop, blot – पोंछना

Practice Exercise



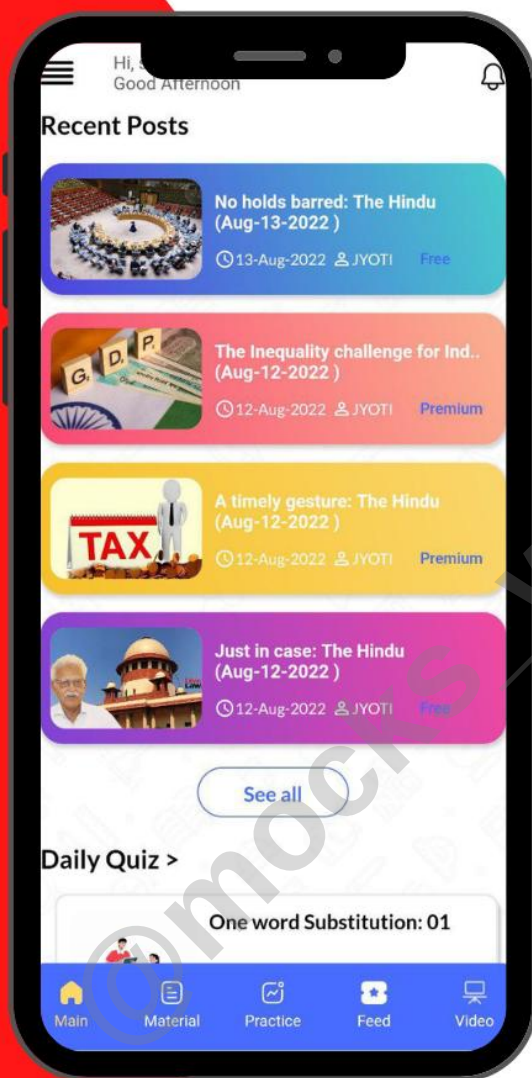
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